

nectivity alert. I need to reboot the laptop for the connection to work again. What could be wrong?

A Somehow Vista is not reinitialising the network adapter when it returns from standby. This could be to do with the power saving settings for the network adapter. To fix this, start Device Manager from the start menu. Under Network adapters, look for your adapter. Double-click on it. Look for a power management tab and uncheck the option for Switch off the device to save power. This should fix the problem.

Upgrading Vista

Q I have some machines with Vista Home Premium and I have recently bought Ultimate licenses for them. When I try to upgrade from Vista Home Premium, it refuses to, with an error stating that I cannot upgrade from a staged build to a non-staged version. I have 32-bit versions of Vista and the same problem occurs with and without SP1 installed. Why is this happening?

A You will have to do a clean install for this. For OEM versions of Vista, there is an upgrade option built into the OS.

Tweaking Cleartype

Q I have used Cleartype fonts on Vista for my LCD display. The fonts look too fat and ugly and they are getting a little irritating to read. Is there no tweaking software for it?

A There is an online Cleartype tweaker available on Microsoft's site. The page is meant for Windows XP, but it works on Vista as well. Visit <http://www.microsoft.com/typography/cleartype/tuner/tune.aspx>. Choose to enable Cleartype and then follow the steps in the wizard.

Where's The Sidebar?

Q I remember disabling sidebar immediately after installing, but now when I try to turn it on, it doesn't come back. It gives me an error saying Windows sidebar is managed by the system administrator.